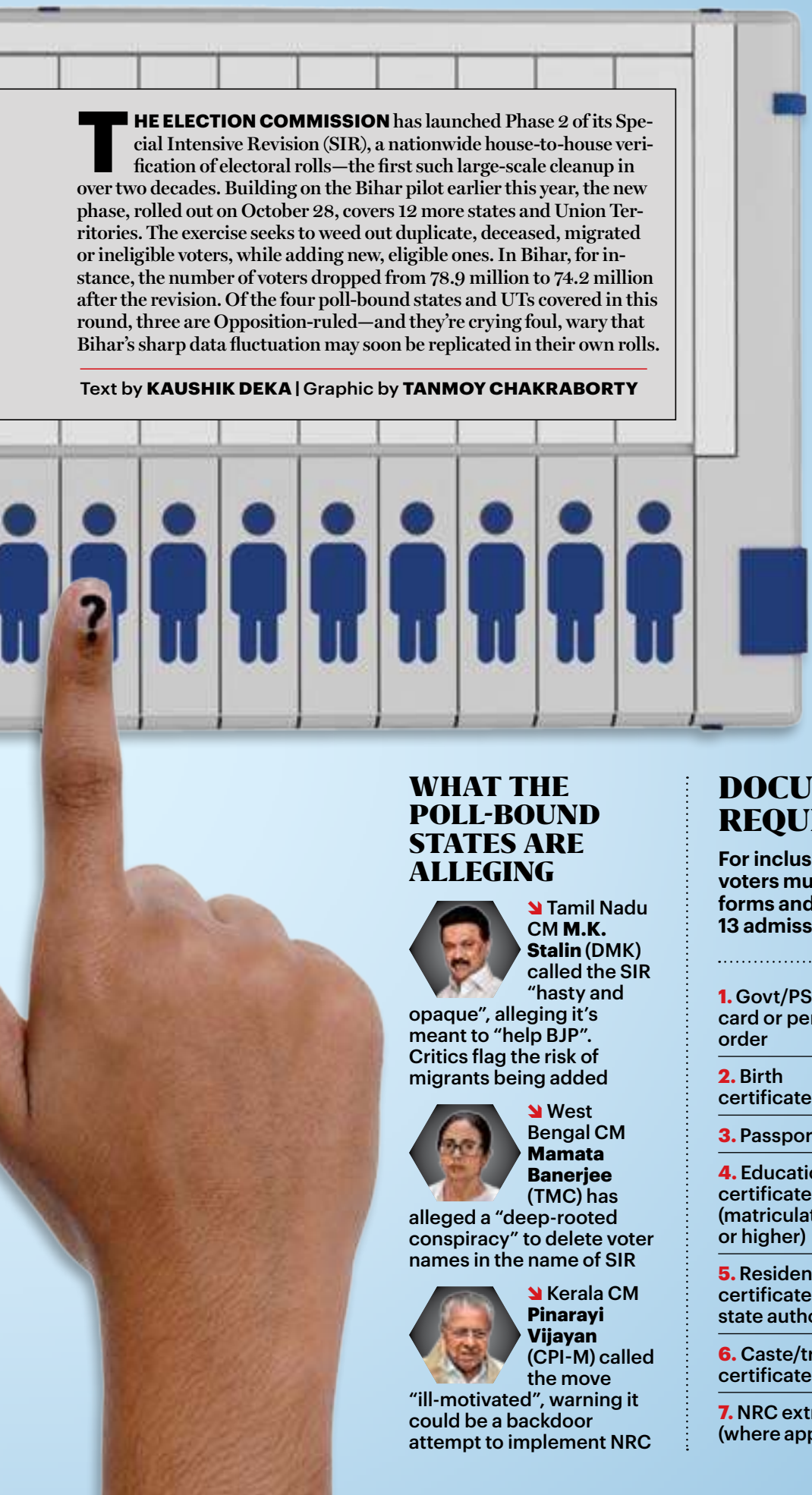
THE ELECTION COMMISSION has launched Phase 2 of its Special Intensive Revision (SIR), a nationwide house-to-house verification of electoral rolls—the first such large-scale cleanup in over two decades. Building on the Bihar pilot earlier this year, the new phase, rolled out on October 28, covers 12 more states and Union Territories. The exercise seeks to weed out duplicate, deceased, migrated or ineligible voters, while adding new, eligible ones. In Bihar, for instance, the number of voters dropped from 78.9 million to 74.2 million after the revision. Of the four poll-bound states and UTs covered in this round, three are Opposition-ruled—and they're crying foul, wary that Bihar's sharp data fluctuation may soon be replicated in their own rolls.

Text by **KAUSHIK DEKA** | Graphic by **TANMOY CHAKRABORTY**



HOW IT WILL BE DONE

- Voter lists of the 12 states/UTs frozen now
- Voters will be matched against the 2002-04 voting lists; available on voters.eci.gov.in
- All voters on that list will be given Unique Enumeration Forms by booth-level officers (BLOs)
- At the pre-enumeration stage, BLOs will fill these forms. They will go door-to-door at least thrice for each voter's verification
- Individuals (or their parents) listed in the 2002–04 rolls will not be required to provide additional proof; filling out the form will suffice
- Those who have temporarily migrated or are unavailable during office hours can complete the verification process online on their own

WHAT THE POLL-BOUND STATES ARE ALLEGING

- Tamil Nadu CM **M.K. Stalin** (DMK) called the SIR "hasty and opaque", alleging it's meant to "help BJP". Critics flag the risk of migrants being added

- West Bengal CM **Mamata Banerjee** (TMC) has alleged a "deep-rooted conspiracy" to delete voter names in the name of SIR

- Kerala CM **Pinarayi Vijayan** (CPI-M) called the move "ill-motivated", warning it could be a backdoor attempt to implement NRC

DOCUMENTS REQUIRED

For inclusion/ verification, voters must fill enumeration forms and provide any of these 13 admissible documents

1. Govt/PSU ID card or pension order
2. Birth certificate
3. Passport
4. Educational certificate (matriculation or higher)
5. Residence certificate by state authority
6. Caste/tribe certificate
7. NRC extract (where applicable)
8. Family register
9. Land/house allotment certificate
10. Forest rights certificate
11. Identity certificate issued before Jul. 1, 1987
12. Bihar SIR roll extract (for parental proof)
13. Aadhaar, but only as identity proof, not citizenship